

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

POEM: THE VOICE OF THE RAIN

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

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Topics To Covered

1 ... *Poem: (The voice of the rain)*

2 ... Detailed Explanation

3 ...

4 ...

The Voice of the Rain Walt Whitman

And who ^{who are you?} art ^{are you} thou? said I to the soft-falling shower,
Which, strange to tell, gave me an answer, as here translated:

I am the ^{Song} Poem of Earth, said the voice of the rain,
Eternal I rise impalpable out of the land and the bottomless sea,

Personification:

Speaker is Rain.

The poet asks the softly falling rain who it is. Surprisingly, the rain replies that it is the "Poem of Earth." It explains that it rises invisibly and eternally from the land and sea in the form of vapour. This shows the rain as a natural, eternal, and poetic voice of the earth.

Eternal: never ending, everlasting

Impalpable: something that cannot be touched

Poetic Devices

1. Personification:

The rain is given human qualities, such as the ability to speak and respond.

Example: “said I to the soft-falling shower... gave me an answer...”

2. Metaphor:

The rain calls itself the “Poem of Earth,” comparing itself to poetry, which is also a natural and beautiful expression, without using “like” or “as”.

3. Imagery:

The poet uses descriptive language to create a visual and sensory image.

Example: “soft-falling shower” and “bottomless sea” help readers imagine the gentle rain and vastness of the ocean.

Poetic Devices

4. Alliteration:

Repetition of consonant sounds at the beginning of nearby words.

Example: “soft-falling shower” – repetition of the ‘s’ sound creates a soothing tone.

5. Enjambment:

The sentence flows beyond one line into the next without a pause, reflecting the continuous motion of rain.

Example: Lines 2 to 4 are part of a single flowing sentence.

6. Symbolism:

The rain symbolizes natural cycles, life, and creativity. Calling it a poem suggests that nature itself is a form of art.

QUESTION



Who is the speaker in the poem?

- 1 The Earth
- 2 The Rain ~~✓~~
- 3 The Poet ✓
- 4 The Cloud

QUESTION



What does the rain call itself?

- 1 Music of Heaven
- 2 Whisper of Nature
- 3 Dance of Clouds
- 4 Poem of Earth ✓✓

QUESTION



From where does the rain rise?

- 1 Land and the bottomless sea 
- 2 Rivers and ponds
- 3 Leaves and plants
- 4 Sky and air

The Voice of the Rain *Walt Whitman*

Upward to ^{sky} heaven, ^{From where} whence, ^{undoubtedly} vaguely form'd, altogether changed, and yet the same,
 I ^{come down} descend to ^{wash} lave the ^{dryness} droughts, atomies, dust-layers of the globe,
 And all that in them without me were seeds only, ^{hidden} latent, unborn;

The rain says it rises to the sky as vapour and becomes a cloud—changing in form but not in essence. It then falls to the earth, washing away dryness and dust. It helps seeds hidden in the soil to grow by giving them water and life.

Whence: from where

Descend: come down

Lave: To wash

atomies: Tiny particles

Latent: hidden

Poetic Devices



1. Personification

Definition: Giving human traits to non-human things.

Explanation: The rain speaks in the first person, acts with purpose, and gives life.

Example:

“I descend...”

“I give back life...”

These are human actions, making the rain a speaking and thoughtful character.

2. Paradox

Definition: A statement that seems contradictory but holds truth.

Line: “altogether changed, and yet the same”

Explanation: Though the rain changes form (from water to vapour to cloud to rain again), its identity and essence remain unchanged. This reflects the continuity of natural cycles.

Poetic Devices



3. Imagery

Definition: Descriptive language that appeals to the senses.

Explanation: The stanza paints vivid pictures of the rain's journey and its impact on Earth.

Examples: "lave the drouths" – appeals to the sense of touch (washing dry land)

"dust-layers of the globe" – visual image

"latent, unborn" – evokes the idea of life waiting to emerge

4. Symbolism

Definition: Use of symbols to represent larger ideas.

Explanation:

Rain symbolizes life, renewal, purity, and the creative cycle of nature.

Seeds represent hidden potential, which only rain can awaken.

The cycle of rising and falling reflects eternity and the natural rhythm of life.

Poetic Devices



5. Enjambment

Definition: The continuation of a sentence across multiple lines without a pause.

Explanation: The four lines are part of one flowing sentence. This mirrors the continuous and unbroken cycle of rain.

Effect: Creates a smooth, natural rhythm and connects the ideas seamlessly.

6. Contrast/Juxtaposition

Definition: Placing two opposite ideas side by side for effect.

Example: “altogether changed, and yet the same” – highlights the dual nature of the rain (form vs. essence)

“latent, unborn” vs. “I give back life” – shows how rain transforms lifeless things into living ones.

Change / Same

QUESTION



What does the rain do when it descends?

- 1 Makes the sky cloudy
- 2 Hides the sun
- 3 Washes dust and drought 
- 4 Forms new clouds

QUESTION



What would seeds remain without rain?

- 1 Wet
- 2 Growth
- 3 hidden ~~Dormant~~ and unborn 
- 4 Ripe

The Voice of the Rain *Walt Whitman*

And forever, by day and night, I give back life to my own origin,
 And make pure and beautify it:
 (For poem starting singer/poet issuing from its birth-place, after fulfilment, wandering
 Reck'd or unreck'd, duly properly with love returns.)

The rain says that it continually returns life to the earth—its own origin—day and night. It purifies and beautifies nature through its presence. In the final two lines, the poet compares the rain to a song or poem. Just like rain, a poem comes from the poet's soul, fulfills its purpose in the world, and returns to the poet—whether people value it (reck'd) or not (unreck'd). This highlights the eternal and selfless cycle of creation, whether in nature or art.

Issuing: starting

Reck'd or unreck'd:
whether cared for or not

Duly: Properly

Poetic Devices



1. Personification

The rain is personified—it speaks in first person, “I give back life...,” and performs conscious actions like purifying and beautifying.

Even the “song” in the comparison is treated like a living being that wanders and returns with love.

2. Symbolism

Rain symbolizes life, purity, and nature’s creative power.

Song symbolizes art, poetry, or creative expression.

The cycle of rain/song returning to its origin reflects the eternal rhythm of nature and art.

Poetic Devices



3. Metaphor

A direct comparison between rain and a song or poem is made.

Example:

“For song, issuing from its birth-place...” compares the journey of rain to the journey of a song from the poet’s soul to the world and back.

No “like” or “as” is used—making it a metaphor, not a simile.

4. Enjambment

The sentences flow beyond one line without a pause, continuing the natural rhythm of thought—like rain or a song continuing its journey.

QUESTION



What is the poem trying to compare rain with?

- 1 Music
- 2 Thunder
- 3 Magic
- 4 Poetry/song ✓

QUESTION



What happens to the rain in the sky?

- 1 Changes form but remains the same ~~✗~~
- 2 It disappears
- 3 Becomes wind
- 4 Turns into snow

QUESTION



There are two voices in the poem. Who do they belong to? Which lines indicate this?

ANSWER:

In the poem, the two voices belong to the poet and the rain. The poet asks a question to the rain, and to his surprise, it responds. This conversation between the two is reflected in the lines: "And who art thou? said I to the soft-falling shower. Which, strange to tell, gave me an answer, as here translated." These lines show that the poet is curious about the identity of the rain, and the rain replies to him in a human-like voice, which the poet then translates for the readers.

QUESTION



What does the phrase “strange to tell” mean?

ANSWER:

The phrase “strange to tell” means that something is unusual or surprising to share. In the poem, it refers to the unexpected response of the rain to the poet’s question. Normally, we don’t expect natural elements like rain to talk, so when the rain gives a reply, the poet is surprised and finds it a strange and remarkable experience worth mentioning.

QUESTION



There is a parallel drawn between rain and music. Which words indicate this? What is the similarity between the two?

ANSWER:

The poet draws a beautiful parallel between rain and music, particularly by calling rain the “Poem of Earth.” This description indicates that rain, like music, is soothing and has a rhythm and life of its own. The similarity between rain and music lies in their origin and effect. Both rise from the earth (rain as vapor, music as thought or feeling), travel through space, perform their function of refreshing or touching people, and eventually return to their place of origin. Just like music brings joy and returns to the soul, the rain nourishes the earth and goes back to the sky, forming a continuous cycle.

QUESTION



How is the cyclic movement of rain brought out in the poem? Compare it with what you have learnt in science.

ANSWER:

The poem beautifully presents the cyclic nature of rain. It describes how the rain rises from the land and sea in the form of vapor, then floats up into the sky where it changes into clouds. Eventually, it falls back to the earth as rain, bringing life and nourishment to the ground. This process repeats endlessly. Scientifically, this is the water cycle, which includes evaporation, condensation, precipitation, and collection. Both the poem and science emphasize that rain is part of a never-ending natural process that sustains life on Earth.

QUESTION



Why are the last two lines put within brackets?

ANSWER:

The last two lines of the poem are placed within brackets because they serve as the poet's own reflection rather than part of the conversation with the rain. They express the poet's observation about the nature of both rain and music. He compares rain to a song that, even after wandering far, returns to its origin with love. The brackets help to separate this philosophical commentary from the main dialogue in the poem.

QUESTION



List the pair of opposites found in the poem.

ANSWER:

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The poem contains several pairs of opposites that highlight the natural balance in the cycle of rain. Some of these include “day and night,” which represent the passage of time, and “reck’d and unreck’d,” meaning noticed and unnoticed. These opposites underline the idea that rain benefits all, whether its presence is acknowledged or not. The contrast also reflects the broader themes of nature’s harmony and the continual give-and-take relationship between the earth and the elements.

Thank
You